



124 Down To Earth



126 Face Off

Digital Business

How Technology Can Help Your Organisation

Tech Careers

Slash And Burn

What does it take to make a blockbuster out of raw footage? The answer is, quite simply, post-production techniques

Samir Makwana

It's the special effects in movies such as *The Matrix*, *Terminator 3*, *Lord of the Rings*, the *Star Wars* trilogy, and many more that are responsible for much of their appeal and, as you probably know, those effects are made possible with the assistance of computer-generated imagery. In fact, a good home-grown example would be the 90 minutes of special-effects scenes in the recently-released movie *Krrish*. Yes, the scenes were designed entirely in India!

Though it is still in the developmental stage, television as a communication medium is getting more powerful. New channels are coming in, and some are falling by the wayside. The competition is intense. But it is for this very reason, and because television needs a minimum of 20 to 25 programmes per week per channel, that the scope for growth of the television medium is immense.

The production process of a movie or TV programme can be broadly divided into pre-production, production, and post-production. The first of these involves the planning of all the activities to be undertaken in the next two stages. Production is where actions are performed according to the script and are recorded. The process after the shoot is

recorded is known as post-production, which involves putting together of the whole programme and giving it a final shape, replete with animation, graphics, and special effects.

"The Indian entertainment industry is on a high growth path, and now enjoys a respectable position on the global map. The industry, earlier referred to as unorganised, is now moving towards compartmentalisation of each task involved in the post-production process. Awareness amongst people about opportunities in post-production still falls short," says Raman Madan, regional manager, Animation and Desktop Video, South East Asia and India, Autodesk Media and Entertainment Solutions.

The post-production crew, naturally, plays an important role in turning the raw footage into a polished entertainment package. It's the art of transforming imagination or concepts into scenes with help of technical excellence and multimedia graphics. Ask yourself if "Graphical Imagery," "Special Effects," "Visual Effects," and "Editing" excite you—and you'd have the answer to whether you'd like to get into post-production.

The How And The What

A comfortable way would be to get a degree from an institute that provides education and training in

